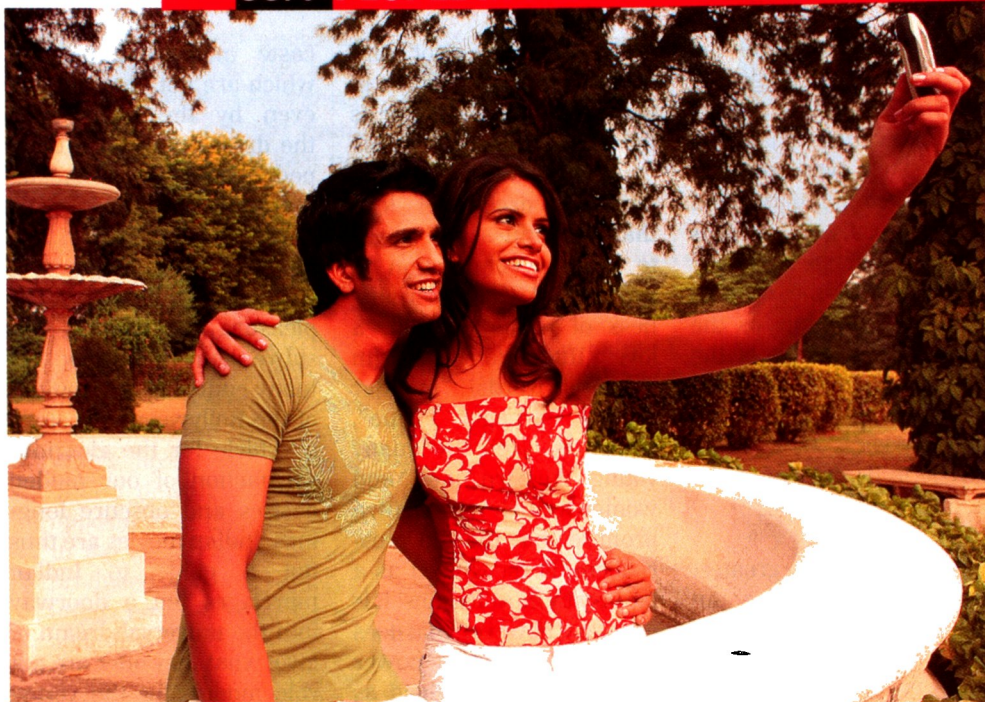


88% PEOPLE IN DELHI PREFER TO HAVE ARRANGED MARRIAGES



How often do you go on a vacation with your family?

		MALE	FEMALE
Once in a year	32	27	37
Once in three months/more often	16	19	14
Once in six months	16	18	14
Once in two-three years	14	14	15
Less often	9	9	9
Never go out	9	10	7

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

THE BREAKAWAY CLUB

Whereas 32 per cent respondents go on family vacations once a year, more females (37 per cent) than males (27 per cent) prefer such vacations. Ludhiana scores the highest with 44 per cent going on an annual holiday and Hyderabad the lowest (22 per cent).

the possible blot on her reputation which will make her soiled goods in the marriage market and adversely affect the marriage prospects of her siblings. Which explains why 69 per cent of the respondents have never had sex before marriage and 30 per cent confirm with their spouse if he or she is a virgin.

As for the future, the fate of arranged marriages is tied to changes in our vision of the right balance between the demands of the larger family and those of the couple. Such a change is evident. More people (23 per cent) in the age group of 21 to 30 have had love marriage than in the 31 to 40 age group. I believe there is still room for a greater accentuation of the couple in our family life, a needed corrective to the excessive "familism", governing our intimate relationships. But if the balance tilts completely, if the couple becomes all-conquering in Indian imagination, then it can become a fortress that shuts out all other relationships. The couple's intimacy can easily degenerate into a mutual ego boosting, a joint self-centredness. If the dream of constituting a two-person universe becomes all-consuming, then arranged marriages may find it harder to survive.

The writer is a psychoanalyst and author of The Indians

romantically or erotically imperious and that it does not have to prefigure marriage but can waft in gently afterwards, sometimes may be years later when the couple is well into adulthood.

Traditionally, there were, of course, objective conditions for the likelihood of the couple falling in love after marriage. The hormonal pressure created

by enforced celibacy during youth, and a lack of experience with the opposite sex, ensure that the young person is biologically and emotionally primed to fall in love if the marriage partner is even reasonably satisfactory. In fact, arranged marriages work best, and perhaps can only work, if the sexes are kept apart in youth and if marriages take

place early, before young men and women have had an opportunity to compare a range of potential partners. But even among the metropolitan elite, with a freer mixing between the sexes, the very existence of arranged marriage puts a mental roadblock in the way of a young person's, especially a young girl's, sexual experimentation because of

THE DOCTOR CAME LATE.
THE NURSE WAS GLAD.

KAMASUTRA LONGLAST. CLIMAX CONTROL DOTTED CONDOMS.
WHO DO YOU WANT TO BE TONIGHT?

